1. Company Overview

NovaTech Solutions is a technology company specializing in cloud platforms, artificial intelligence, enterprise software, and digital transformation.

The company operates offices in Bengaluru, Hyderabad, and Pune, India, and maintains a smaller engineering office in Austin, Texas, USA.

NovaTech employs software engineers, product managers, designers, quality assurance engineers, customer support specialists, and administrative professionals.

All employees are expected to follow company policies regarding professional conduct, confidentiality, working hours, information security, and workplace communication.

2. Working Hours Policy

Policy ID: HR-2026-WH-001

The standard working schedule for full-time employees in India is **40 hours per week**, distributed over five working days.

Normal business hours are Monday through Friday, from 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM, including a one-hour lunch break.

Employees may begin work between 8:00 AM and 10:00 AM with manager approval, provided they complete their required working hours.

Employees are expected to attend mandatory meetings, project discussions, and scheduled team activities during agreed collaboration hours.

Weekend work requires prior approval from the reporting manager. Where applicable, compensatory time off may be granted according to company policy.

3. Remote Work and Hybrid Workplace Policy

Policy ID: HR-2026-RW-002

NovaTech follows a hybrid work model for eligible employees.

Employees assigned to Indian offices may work remotely for **up to two days per week**, subject to team requirements and manager approval.

Employees are normally expected to work from their designated office for at least three days per week.

Working from home (WFH), remote working, and telecommuting refer to the same hybrid-work arrangement under this policy.

Employees must maintain a reliable internet connection, attend scheduled meetings, and remain reachable through approved communication channels.

Fully remote arrangements require written approval from Human Resources and the department head.

Employees working remotely must comply with all company data protection and cybersecurity policies.

4. Probation and Confirmation

Policy ID: HR-2026-EMP-003

Newly hired full-time employees generally complete a probationary period of **six months**.

During probation, employees are assessed on job performance, technical ability, teamwork, communication, and adherence to workplace policies.

Managers conduct a performance review before the probationary period ends.

Successful completion results in written confirmation of employment.

The probationary period may be extended by up to three months where additional evaluation is necessary, subject to applicable employment terms.

5. Annual Leave Policy

Policy ID: HR-2026-LV-042

Full-time permanent employees in India receive **24 working days of paid annual leave per calendar year**.

Annual leave is sometimes described as vacation leave, paid vacation, or paid time off for planned personal activities.

New employees receive annual leave on a prorated basis according to their joining date.

Employees should submit planned leave requests through the HR self-service portal at least five working days before the requested absence.

Approval depends on team staffing, project commitments, operational requirements, and the reporting manager's decision.

Employees may take consecutive annual leave days, provided the request is approved and sufficient leave balance is available.

Annual leave does not normally include weekends or designated public holidays.

6. Annual Leave Carry-Forward

Policy ID: HR-2026-LV-043

Employees may carry forward a maximum of **10 unused annual leave days** into the next calendar year.

Any unused annual leave exceeding the 10-day carry-forward limit normally expires on December 31, unless an approved exception applies.

Carried-forward leave must be used before September 30 of the following year.

For example, an employee with 14 unused annual leave days at the end of 2026 may carry forward 10 days into 2027. The remaining four days expire under the standard policy.

Employees should review their leave balance through the HR portal before the end of each year.

The carry-forward rule applies to annual leave only. Sick leave and casual leave follow separate rules.

7. Sick Leave Policy

Policy ID: HR-2026-LV-044

Full-time employees in India receive **12 paid sick leave days per calendar year**.

Sick leave is intended for illness, injury, medical recovery, or health conditions that prevent an employee from working.

Employees should inform their manager as early as possible when taking unexpected sick leave.

A medical certificate may be required when an employee takes more than three consecutive working days of sick leave.

Unused sick leave cannot be carried forward to the next calendar year.

Sick leave cannot ordinarily be converted into cash.

Employees recovering from a prolonged illness may contact Human Resources to discuss additional leave options.

8. Casual Leave Policy

Policy ID: HR-2026-LV-045

Employees receive **six casual leave days annually** for unexpected personal matters, urgent family obligations, or short personal appointments.

Casual leave may be taken in half-day or full-day increments, subject to approval.

Unused casual leave expires at the end of the calendar year and cannot be carried forward.

Casual leave is separate from annual leave and sick leave.

9. Public Holidays

Policy ID: HR-2026-HOL-046

Employees working in India receive **10 designated public holidays per calendar year**, based on their assigned office location.

The company publishes the annual holiday calendar before the beginning of each year.

Public holidays are separate from annual leave, sick leave, and casual leave balances.

Employees required to work on designated holidays may be eligible for compensatory time off, subject to manager and HR approval.

10. Maternity Leave Policy

Policy ID: HR-2026-PL-051

Eligible employees in India may receive **up to 26 weeks of paid maternity leave**, subject to applicable law and eligibility requirements.

Employees should notify Human Resources in advance and provide the required documentation.

Where permitted by law and company policy, a portion of maternity leave may be taken before the expected delivery date.

Employees returning from maternity leave may request temporary flexible working arrangements, subject to business requirements.

Maternity leave does not reduce an employee's standard annual leave entitlement.

The company will comply with statutory maternity benefit requirements where those requirements differ from the general handbook description.

11. Paternity and Partner Leave

Policy ID: HR-2026-PL-052

Eligible full-time employees may receive **10 working days of paid paternity or partner leave** following the birth or qualifying adoption of a child.

Employees should ordinarily use this leave within 90 days of the qualifying event.

Partner leave is separate from annual leave and does not reduce the employee's vacation balance.

Leave requests should be submitted through the HR portal with supporting documentation where required.

12. Health Insurance Benefits

Policy ID: HR-2026-BEN-061

NovaTech provides eligible full-time Indian employees with employer-sponsored group medical insurance.

The standard annual family-floater coverage limit is ₹**5,00,000** per covered family.

Eligible dependents may include a spouse and dependent children, subject to the insurer's policy terms.

Coverage generally includes hospitalization, eligible surgical procedures, and other medical services specified in the insurance plan.

Employees may review coverage details, exclusions, deductibles, and network hospitals through the benefits portal.

Optional enhanced insurance coverage may be available at additional employee cost.

Health insurance coverage is distinct from sick leave entitlements. Employees may use sick leave even when no hospitalization or insurance claim is involved.

13. Preventive Healthcare and Wellness

Policy ID: HR-2026-BEN-062

Eligible employees may claim reimbursement of up to ₹**8,000 per calendar year** for approved preventive healthcare and wellness expenses.

Eligible categories may include annual health checkups, preventive screenings, and approved fitness or wellness programs.

Claims require valid invoices and must be submitted through the benefits portal.

Unused wellness allowances cannot be carried forward into the next year.

The wellness benefit is independent of the ₹5,00,000 group medical insurance coverage.

14. Mental Health and Employee Assistance

Policy ID: HR-2026-BEN-063

NovaTech offers confidential employee assistance resources for stress management, workplace challenges, and personal wellbeing.

Eligible employees may access up to **six confidential counseling sessions annually** through an approved assistance provider.

Participation in counseling is voluntary, and session content is not shared with reporting managers except as required by applicable law or explicitly authorized by the employee.

Employees should contact Human Resources or the employee assistance portal for enrollment details.

15. Work-From-Home Equipment Allowance

Policy ID: HR-2026-EXP-071

Eligible employees may claim a **one-time home-office setup allowance of up to ₹15,000**.

The allowance can be used for approved equipment such as an external monitor, keyboard, mouse, ergonomic chair, or laptop stand.

Claims must be supported by valid purchase invoices and submitted within 60 days of the purchase date.

The allowance is intended for work-related equipment and does not cover personal entertainment devices.

Employees should obtain approval before purchasing unusually expensive equipment.

This home-office allowance is separate from the employee's remote-work eligibility.

16. Internet Reimbursement

Policy ID: HR-2026-EXP-072

Employees approved for hybrid or remote work may claim up to **₹1,200 per month** for home internet expenses.

Claims require supporting bills or receipts and must follow the reimbursement submission process.

Unused monthly internet allowance cannot be accumulated or carried forward.

Mobile phone charges are not covered unless the employee has a separately approved business communication allowance.

17. Travel and Accommodation Policy

Policy ID: HR-2026-EXP-073

Business travel must receive manager approval before tickets or accommodation are booked.

Employees should use approved booking channels whenever available.

Reimbursable expenses may include transportation, lodging, and reasonable meals incurred during authorized business travel.

Employees traveling within India may claim actual reasonable meal expenses up to **₹1,500 per travel day**, subject to applicable expense rules.

All expense claims must include valid receipts.

Personal shopping, entertainment, and expenses unrelated to approved business travel are not reimbursable.

Travel expenses should be submitted within 30 days after the trip ends.

18. Learning and Development Budget

Policy ID: HR-2026-LND-081

NovaTech encourages continuous professional development.

Eligible full-time employees receive an annual learning budget of up to ₹**30,000** for approved training and education.

The allowance may be used for professional certifications, technical courses, conferences, and job-related learning programs.

Employees must obtain manager approval before purchasing a course or registering for an event.

Examples of eligible subjects include cloud architecture, software engineering, artificial intelligence, cybersecurity, and project management.

Unused learning budget cannot be carried forward to the next year.

The learning allowance cannot be exchanged for salary or cash compensation.

19. Performance Review and Promotion

Policy ID: HR-2026-PERF-082

Employees participate in two formal performance review cycles each year.

The mid-year review generally takes place in June, while the annual review takes place in December.

Performance is assessed using role expectations, measurable outcomes, collaboration, technical contribution, and professional development.

Promotions are based on demonstrated readiness, business requirements, available positions, and management approval.

Completing a particular number of years at the company does not automatically guarantee promotion.

Performance bonuses, where applicable, are determined according to employment terms and company policy.

20. Information Security Policy

Policy ID: IT-2026-SEC-091

Employees must protect company systems, customer information, source code, and confidential business data.

All employees must use multifactor authentication for supported company systems.

Passwords, API keys, production credentials, and authentication tokens must not be shared through public chat applications or stored in unapproved locations.

Employees may access company resources only using approved devices and authorized accounts.

Sensitive customer data must not be uploaded to external AI tools without company authorization.

Suspected security incidents should be reported to the security team immediately.

21. Acceptable Use of AI Tools

Policy ID: IT-2026-AI-092

Employees may use approved generative AI tools for software development assistance, documentation, research, and internal productivity.

Confidential source code, customer records, proprietary documents, and credentials must not be submitted to unapproved third-party AI services.

AI-generated code must be reviewed, tested, and validated before use in production systems.

Employees remain responsible for the accuracy and security of work produced with AI assistance.

Any AI application processing confidential company data must follow the company's data governance and security approval process.

22. Resignation and Notice Period

Policy ID: HR-2026-EXIT-101

Confirmed full-time employees in India are generally required to serve a **60-day notice period** when voluntarily resigning, unless their employment agreement specifies otherwise.

Employees serving probation generally have a 30-day notice period unless their employment terms state otherwise.

Notice-period reduction or early release requires written approval from Human Resources and the reporting manager.

Employees must complete knowledge transfer, return company equipment, and resolve outstanding administrative obligations before separation.

The final working date is confirmed through the formal resignation process.

23. Full and Final Settlement

Policy ID: HR-2026-EXIT-102

Following employment separation, NovaTech processes final salary, eligible expense reimbursements, statutory payments, and applicable leave encashment according to employment terms and applicable law.

For eligible employees, unused earned annual leave may be encashed during final settlement, subject to the company's encashment rules and statutory requirements.

Unused sick leave and casual leave are not ordinarily eligible for encashment.

Company-issued laptops, security badges, access cards, and other assigned assets must be returned before clearance is finalized.

Employees can contact Human Resources for information about settlement status and required documentation.

24. Frequently Asked Questions

Q1. How many paid vacation days are provided annually?

Eligible full-time employees in India receive 24 annual leave days per calendar year. This is the same benefit described as annual leave or paid vacation.

Q2. Can employees transfer unused vacation days to the following year?

Yes. Employees may carry forward up to 10 unused annual leave days. These days must be used before September 30 of the following year.

Q3. Are sick leave days part of the 24 annual leave days?

No. Employees receive 12 sick leave days separately from their 24 annual leave days.

Q4. How often can employees work from home?

Eligible employees may work remotely up to two days per week, with manager approval.

Q5. Does the company reimburse home internet expenses?

Yes. Eligible employees may claim up to ₹1,200 per month for approved home internet expenses.

Q6. What is the company learning allowance?

Eligible employees receive up to ₹30,000 annually for approved professional learning activities.

Q7. What is the standard resignation notice period?

Confirmed full-time employees in India generally serve a 60-day notice period, unless their employment agreement states otherwise.

Q8. Can employees use public generative AI tools with confidential documents?

No. Confidential company or customer information must not be uploaded to unapproved third-party AI services.